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Pasta al Forno

with Pumpkin and Prosciutto

The best restaurant dishes are always worth recreating at home. For this hands-off (read: knife-free) recipe, Food52 co-founder and president Merrill Stubbs shares a truly memorable baked pasta she once enjoyed with her husband: “Rich, lightly sweet, but also tangy from the blend of different cheeses, the pasta was tinted a rich orange throughout." That's all thanks to seasonal pumpkin folded into a luscious cream sauce.

30–40 minutes 900 calories per serving

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Ingredients

- ⅛ ounce thyme
- 2 ounces prosciutto, divided
- 8 ounces rigatoni
- 1 ounce grated Parmesan cheese
- ¾ cup pumpkin purée
- 2 ounces shredded Fontina cheese, divided
- 1 container heavy cream
- 1 parchment paper
- 1 aluminum tin

You'll need

kosher salt
black pepper
8" medium pot
baking sheet

Recipe tips

Be sure to read through the entire recipe before you begin cooking.

Forno, Italian for oven, indicates dishes that are baked or roasted. In Step 5, the final blast helps melt the cheese, set the sauce, and brown the edges of the noodles.

Here's a cheffy trick for picking thyme leaves all at once: Pinch the stem near the top with 1 hand, then slide the fingers of your other hand down the length of the stem, from top to bottom. The leaves will come off easily.

Save remaining cream for another recipe.

Placing the tin on a baking sheet helps stabilize the pasta for even cooking and easy transfer in and out of the oven.

Questions? Email help@plated.com or call 855-525-2399. Visit plated.me/allergens for more information on dietary restrictions.

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1. Prepare ingredients

Preheat oven to 350°F (see recipe tip). Bring a medium pot of water to a boil over high heat. Strip **thyme** leaves, discarding stems (see recipe tip).



2. Crisp prosciutto

Line a baking sheet with **parchment paper**, then add **prosciutto slices** in a single layer. Bake until beginning to crisp, 15–18 minutes (move on to Step 3, but don't forget to come back!). Then, remove **prosciutto** from oven and set aside to cool—it might not look perfectly crisp when it first comes out of the oven, but will crisp up fully when cooled.



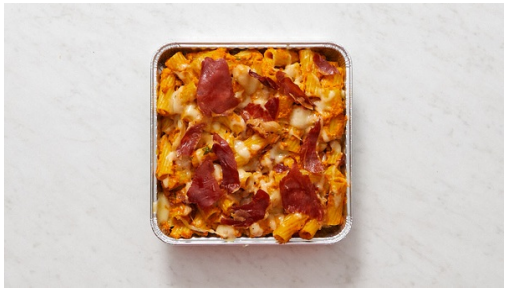
3. Cook rigatoni

Season boiling water generously with **salt**. Stir in **rigatoni** and cook until al dente, about 11 minutes. (Use the remaining downtime while you wait for the prosciutto to crisp to kick back and relax.) Then, drain **rigatoni** and return to pot, off heat.



4. Finish pasta

Once cool enough to handle, crumble **half of prosciutto**; break **remainder** into bite-size pieces for the next step. Remove and discard **parchment**, reserving baking sheet for the next step. To pot with cooked rigatoni, still off heat, stir in **Parmesan**, **pumpkin purée**, **⅓ cup heavy cream**, **thyme**, **crumbled prosciutto**, and **half of Fontina** (see recipe tip). Season with **½ teaspoon salt** and **pepper**.



5. Bake pasta

Reshape **aluminum tin** if bent, then place on baking sheet from prosciutto (see recipe tip). Transfer **pumpkin pasta** to tin and spread in an even layer. Sprinkle over **remaining Fontina** and scatter over **remaining prosciutto**. Transfer sheet to oven and bake until cheese is melted and pasta is warmed through, 7–9 minutes.



6. Plate pasta al forno

Let **pasta al forno** cool for about 5 minutes (this is a great time to set the table), then divide between serving plates. Dig in!

Recipe adapted from Food52.

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